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INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE LT02

Unit 2 Place in literary texts

Mark scheme

June 2022

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2 2 6 X L T 0 2 / M S

Mark schemes are prepared by the Lead Assessment Writer and considered, together with the relevant questions, by a panel of subject teachers. This mark scheme includes any amendments made at the standardisation events which all associates participate in and is the scheme which was used by them in this examination. The standardisation process ensures that the mark scheme covers the students' responses to questions and that every associate understands and applies it in the same correct way. As preparation for standardisation each associate analyses a number of students' scripts. Alternative answers not already covered by the mark scheme are discussed and legislated for. If, after the standardisation process, associates encounter unusual answers which have not been raised they are required to refer these to the Lead Examiner.

It must be stressed that a mark scheme is a working document, in many cases further developed and expanded on the basis of students' reactions to a particular paper. Assumptions about future mark schemes on the basis of one year's document should be avoided; whilst the guiding principles of assessment remain constant, details will change, depending on the content of a particular examination paper.

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Information for Examiners

Welcome to this mark scheme which is designed to help you to deliver fair and accurate assessment. Please read carefully all sections and ensure that you follow the requirements that they contain.

Arriving at Marks

- 1 All questions are framed to address all the Assessment Objectives (AOs). Answers are marked holistically and when deciding upon a mark in a band, examiners should bear in mind the equal weightings of the assessment objectives. Examiners need to read the whole answer, taking into account its strengths and weaknesses, and then place it in the appropriate band.
- 2 Examiners should avoid making early snap judgements before the whole answer has been read. Some candidates begin tentatively but go on to make relevant points.
- 3 Examiners should be prepared to use the full mark range and not 'bunch' scripts in the middle for safety. Top marks are attainable if candidates could not be expected to do more in the time and under the conditions in which they are working.
- 4 Examiners should mark positively. Although the mark scheme provides some indicators for what candidates are likely to write about, examiners should be willing to reward what is actually there – provided, of course, that it is relevant to the question being asked.
- 5 Examiners should remember that there are no right answers. Candidates' views which are relevant, well-argued and supported by appropriate textual evidence must receive credit whether the examiner agrees with the views or not. It is important to try to remain flexible if a candidate introduces unusual or unorthodox ideas.
- 6 Examiners should remember that length and quality are not synonymous. Some brief answers may be relevant and concise. Equally, long answers may be diffuse and repetitive.
- 7 If answers are short or incomplete, examiners can reward only what is there and assess accordingly. Some further credit may be given to answers finished in note form.

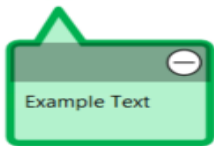
Using the Mark Bands

- 8 When placing answers in mark bands, examiners need to look closely at the descriptors and the detailed generic mark bands on pages 6–9. The key words for the bands are important and are printed below.

MARK BAND DESCRIPTORS	
Band 5	perceptive/assured
Band 4	coherent/thorough
Band 3	straightforward/relevant
Band 2	simple/generalised
Band 1	largely irrelevant, largely misunderstood, largely inaccurate

- 9 Answers placed at the top of the band will securely address the descriptors; answers at the lower end of the band will securely address the descriptors below and begin to show the qualities of the band into which you are placing them. Careful judgements need to be made about marks in the middle of the range; here it is likely that the key descriptors will be more intermittent but still clearly evident.
- 10 There will be occasions when an answer addresses descriptors in different bands; in such cases, the 'best-fit' model applies. Here examiners will need to exercise a different kind of judgement, looking to see where the answer can be most fairly and appropriately placed, in terms of its quality, against the descriptors.
- 11 Examiners must remember that the mark bands are not equivalent to grades: grades are decided by the awarding committee at the end of each session.

The following annotation is available for use on e-Marker 2:

Annotation Name	Toolbar Image	Details	Examples of Use on Script	Y/N
Annotation Type: Stamp				
Correct		Toolbar Tooltip: Correct		Y
Seen		Toolbar Tooltip: Seen		Y
Not Relevant		Toolbar Tooltip: Not Relevant		Y
Red Line		 Toolbar Tooltip: Red Line		Y
Green Empty Comment		Toolbar Tooltip: Green Empty Comment No Default Text - text shown in screenshot was typed into annotation by user		Y
Repetition		Toolbar Tooltip: Repetition		Y
Unfocused		Toolbar Tooltip: Unfocused		Y
Lack Of Clarity		Toolbar Tooltip: Lack of Clarity		Y
Factual Inaccuracy		Toolbar Tooltip: Factual Inaccuracy		Y
Partially Made Point		Toolbar Tooltip: Partially made point		Y

The Assessment Objectives and their significance

- 12 All questions are framed to test AOs 1 and 2 so if candidates answer the question, then they will be addressing the AOs. In marking questions, however, examiners must also take account of AO3, which tests more than technical accuracy.

The equally weighted AOs are as follows:

AO1: Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

AO2: Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

AO3: Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

Mark Scheme

It is important to remember that these students, in the main, are 17 years old so we are judging their skills halfway through Key Stage 5.

	AO	Typical features	How to arrive at mark
Band 5 Perceptive/Assured 21-25 marks ‘Perception’ is demonstrated when students are showing the depth of their understanding and responding sensitively to the texts and task. ‘Assuredness’ is shown when students write with confidence and conviction.	AO1	- Perceptive understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. - Assuredness in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to perceptive interpretations.	This band is characterised by perceptive and assured work which shows confidence, sharpness of mind and sophistication in relation to the task.
	AO2	- Perceptive understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. - Assured engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	At the top of the band students are consistently assured and will demonstrate sensitivity and perception across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response.
	AO3	- Perceptive, assured and sophisticated argument in relation to the task. - Assured use of literary critical concepts and terminology; mature and impressive expression.	At the bottom of the band there will be coherence and accuracy with some perception but with less consistency and evenness.
Band 4 Coherent/Thorough 16-20 marks ‘Coherence’ is shown when students are logical and consistent in their arguments in relation to the task. They hold their ideas together in an intelligible way. ‘Thoroughness’ is shown when students write carefully and precisely with detail.	AO1	- Thorough understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. - Coherence in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to carefully explained interpretations.	This band is characterised by coherent and thorough work where ideas are linked together in a focused and purposeful way in relation to the task.
	AO2	- Thorough understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. - Thorough engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	At the top of the band students will demonstrate a fully coherent and thorough argument across all three assessment objectives in the course of their response.
	AO3	- Logical, thorough and coherent argument in relation to the task where ideas are debated in depth. - Appropriate use of literary critical concepts and terminology; precise and accurate expression.	At the bottom of the band ideas will be discussed in a shaped, relevant and purposeful way with a clear sense of direction, with one or two lapses in coherence and accuracy.

MARK SCHEME – INTERNATIONAL AS LEVEL ENGLISH LITERATURE – LT02 – JUNE 2022

Band 3 Straightforward/ Relevant 11-15 marks ‘Straightforward’ work is shown when students make their ideas in relation to the task clearly known. ‘Relevant’ work is shown when students are focused on the task and use detail in an appropriate and supportive way.	AO1	• Straightforward understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Relevant in the connection between contexts and genre, leading to straightforward interpretations.	This band is characterised by straightforward and relevant work where the student’s response to the task is clear and intelligible. At the top of the band students will demonstrate consistent straightforward understanding in the course of their argument. Ideas will be developed relevantly. At the bottom of the band there will be flashes of relevant understanding with evidence of straightforward thinking.
	AO2	• Straightforward understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Relevant engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• Sensibly ordered ideas in a relevant argument in relation to the task. • Some use of literary critical concepts and terminology which are mainly appropriate; straightforward and clear expression.	
Band 2 Simple/Generalised 6-10 marks ‘Simple’ work is shown when students write in an unelaborated and basic way in relation to the task. ‘Generalised’ work is shown when students write without regard to particular details.	AO1	• Simple understanding of the significance of relevant contexts in relation to the task. • Generalised in the connections between contexts and genre, leading to simple interpretations.	This band is characterised by simple and generalised work which is mainly linked to the task. At the top of the band students will demonstrate a basic generalised understanding in the course of their answer. Ideas will be developed in a simple way. At the bottom of the band there will be inconsistency, but the beginnings of a simple and generalised understanding.
	AO2	• Simple understanding of authorial methods in relation to the task. • Generalised engagement with how meanings are shaped by the methods used.	
	AO3	• A simple structure to the argument which may not be consistent but which does relate to the task. • Generalised use of literary critical concepts and terminology; simple expression.	

Band 1 Largely irrelevant/largely misunderstood/largely inaccurate 1-5 marks ‘Largely irrelevant’ work is shown when students write in an unclear way with only occasional reference to what is required by the question. ‘Largely misunderstood’ and ‘largely inaccurate’ work is shown when knowledge of the text is insecure, hazy and often wrong.	AO1	• Little sense of the AOs in relation to the task; little sense of how meanings are shaped; little sense of any relevant contexts, genre or interpretations.	This band is characterised by work which is largely irrelevant and largely misunderstood and largely inaccurate, and so unlikely to be addressing the AOs in a relevant way. At the top of the band students will mention some unconnected points in relation to the task during the course of their writing. The writing is likely to lack clarity. At the bottom of the band there will be no connection with the task; the writing will be hard to follow and irrelevant.
	AO2	• The writing is likely to be unclear and incorrect; if it is accurate the content will be irrelevant.	
	AO3	• Some vague points in relation to the task and some ideas about task and text(s).	
0 marks		No marks for response when nothing is written or where response has no connection to the text(s) or task.	

0	1
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Joseph Conrad: *Heart of Darkness*

To what extent do you agree that the exploitation of Africa and its people is accepted rather than condemned in *Heart of Darkness*?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Heart of Darkness* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the journey to the Inner Station being part of a colonial enterprise
- setting being a Belgian colony – the Congo Free State
- exploitation of people as well as resources eg corruption of Africans by Kurtz in his acquisition of ivory
- mistreatment of African people eg chain gang and dying workers at the Outer Station
- reactions of Marlow's audience on the Nellie
- ambiguity in Marlow's differing attitudes and comments eg admiration of Kurtz but horrified by his methods; he uses racist language but also recognises humanity of Africans, particularly Kurtz's mistress.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- placing Marlow as narrator at the centre of the British Empire and making his audience beneficiaries of colonial exploitation
- having a narrator for a story of new experiences, who has little knowledge of Africa and colonialism
- structure that follows journey to heart of darkness and climaxes with ambiguity of 'The horror! The horror!'
- symbolism eg ivory as a symbol for the exploitation of natural resources, French warship firing into jungle with contrast to Africans who 'wanted no excuse to be there', shooting of woman who is the 'image of its [Africa's] tenebrous and passionate soul', steamer as representation of colonial enterprise
- motif of gathering darkness and how this implies a variety of meanings, idea of 'heart of darkness' eg link to 'dark continent' and implications of this notion
- imagery, allusion, lexical choices and description eg 'gloomy circle of some Inferno' for grove where African workers are dying.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	2
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F. Scott Fitzgerald: *The Great Gatsby*

'In *The Great Gatsby* Fitzgerald presents a society that is hopelessly divided.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Great Gatsby* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- differences in wealth eg between East Egg and people in valley of ashes, particularly between Buchanans and Wilsons
- how Myrtle Wilson's frustrated attempts to find a better life show insurmountable social barriers
- how class overrides riches eg Gatsby's self-improvement and wealth acquisition end in tragic failure
- the division between old money and new money, with the former having higher status
- a superficially respectable and law-abiding society with criminal underworld – hypocritical attitudes towards bootlegging
- the lower status of women – their objectification, mistreatment and exploitation eg Daisy, Myrtle, women at Gatsby's parties
- examples of hope eg American Dream (Gatsby's aspirations, Myrtle's ambitions), Nick Carraway's moral vision, Michaelis' care for George Wilson.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- geographical divisions as shown by East and West Egg, valley of ashes, New York City and how these show social differences
- the structure of narrative eg the ways in which Gatsby's ambitions and hopes are presented only for them to be dashed at the Plaza Hotel by Tom's revelation of his criminality and his dismissing him as 'Mr Nobody from Nowhere'
- houses as symbols of status, wealth and aspiration with use of descriptive details to show these eg Gatsby's mansion, position of Nick Carraway's small house, the Buchanan house as one of the 'white palaces', the grimness of the Wilson home and workshop
- the separation of East and West Egg 'by a courtesy bay' with symbol of green light for Gatsby's yearning
- the conspicuous consumption and decadence of parties at Gatsby's house in contrast to the effect of the valley of ashes on its inhabitants

- the placing of retrospective vision of 'the last and greatest of all dreams' that 'flowered once for Dutch sailors' at the end of the narrative.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 3

Kazuo Ishiguro: *The Remains of the Day*

Explore the significance of differences in social class as they are presented in *Remains of the Day*.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *The Remains of the Day* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- how social class affects personal relationships and individual attitudes eg Stevens and Miss Kenton, Stevens and his father
- the many differences between upstairs and downstairs at Darlington Hall
- Lord Darlington's political influence and his aristocratic status eg Stevens believing that civilisation lies in the hands of 'great gentleman'
- Stevens' position as butler eg his pride and emphasis on dignity but his role actually demands self-effacement
- changes in social class evident in differences between pre-war and post-war eg new owner of Darlington Hall, Mr Faraday, employs Stevens because he is 'an old-fashioned English butler'
- the episode in Moscombe where Stevens is taken for a 'gentleman' and Harry Smith gives his political views and comments on 'dignity'
- criticism of ruling class through political role of Lord Darlington eg Lewis' comment – 'his Lordship here is an amateur'.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Stevens as a narrator with a clear, approving view of social hierarchy and the aristocracy
- how Stevens functions as an unreliable narrator eg to challenge the status quo
- the country house setting and how different parts of the house help to present differences between the upper class and servants
- how Stevens' journey into the West Country facilitates the introduction of characters from outside Darlington Hall and different attitudes towards social class
- dialogue eg between Lord Darlington and Stevens over the 'forthcoming conference' and the 'dependability' of Stevens' father, the disagreement between Stevens and Miss Kenton over the dismissal of the Jewish maids
- lexical choices, figurative language, irony.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	4
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Aravind Adiga: *Last Man in Tower*

'A community of good neighbours destroyed by progress.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of how Adiga presents the changes to Vishram society?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Last Man in Tower* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- generally harmonious relationships in Tower A before Dharmen Shah's offer eg plastic-chair parliament and 'the whole idea of a Co-operative Housing Society'
- development not necessarily being progress
- benefits of material progress for some residents but community of neighbours is lost
- neighbours join together to conspire against Masterji, who can be seen as selfish and reactionary in resisting what other residents desire
- gradual breaking up of community climaxing with murder of Masterji
- how the deterioration of the relationship between Masterji and the Pintos is a key example of how good neighbours become estranged
- power of money creating division as soon as the offer is made eg Mrs Rego and Mrs Puri.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- how changes of focus on different residents as well as on Dharmen Shah and Shanmugham present different perspectives and attitudes
- the episodic structure with gaps in time, largely chronological with dates for chapter headings
- how the gradual disintegration of the community is presented through such things as dialogue, conflict, different Vishram residents meeting Dharmen Shah and contrasts with Tower B and new developments
- the use of a setting that places neighbours in close proximity and allows different residents to overhear each other
- the use of Masterji as a focus of resistance to 'progress' as it is represented by Dharmen Shah
- the use of symbolism eg Ganesha (remover of obstacles) as emblem of Confidence Group, banyan trees as unstoppable growth and as 'escutcheons of the House of Shah'
- dialogue, lexical choices, figurative language.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0 5 Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie: *Americanah*

'Once they are away from Nigeria neither Ifemelu nor Obinze can escape from the feeling that they do not belong.'

To what extent do you agree with this view of the ways in which these characters are presented?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Americanah* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- race only becoming an issue for Ifemelu in America eg 'I only became black when I came to America'
- Ifemelu's attempts to belong eg faking an American accent, not braiding her hair
- Ifemelu's problems in finding employment, but success as a student and, later, in employment and with her blog
- consideration of Ifemelu's affairs with Curt and Blaine as examples of belonging and/or not belonging
- as an illegal immigrant Obinze does not belong officially
- Obinze's attempts to belong eg agrees to pay for an arranged marriage, assumed identity as 'Vincent', the racism he experiences.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Ifemelu's learning and adopting American idioms and details of accent eg 'You're all set', 'I scored a deal', and 'giving the t its full due in "advantage"'
- symbolism of hair in relation to attempts to belong or to show cultural difference
- arrangement of Obinze's marriage and arrest at registry office used to frame narrative of his time in England, as well as retrospective account failed application for a visa, and his memory of his mother's lie to help him obtain a temporary visa
- Ifemelu's blogs from outsider's point of view eg '... by a Non-American Black'
- structure with Part 1 in recent past and Part 7 covering return to Nigeria with retrospective accounts placed between these
- language features eg dialogue, lexical choices, figurative language, symbolism.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	6
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Andrea Levy: *Small Island*

'In Andrea Levy's *Small Island*, England is not presented as being "small".'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied *Small Island* through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- England being significantly larger geographically than Jamaica, but some of its people are small-minded eg Mr Todd, Bernard
- institutional racism evident in policy of education authority – exclusion of Hortense – and in some of Gilbert's experiences in the British Army
- involvement in world war, and existence of empire showing global power
- 'mother country' implies far-reaching influence
- experiences of Gilbert and Hortense, both pre-war and post-war show racist small-mindedness
- Queenie's story can be seen to challenge small-mindedness through her relationships with Gilbert, Hortense and Michael Roberts.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- how Prologue introduces racist small-mindedness
- use of Before and After structure eg to show background of racism and its continuity for post-war immigrants
- four narrators who offer differing but linked perspectives and stories, eg Queenie and Bernard
- racist language eg 'you people', 'your sort' as well as more obvious abuse
- ending of story with birth and adoption of a mixed-race child suggests hope for a more open, 'larger' society
- presentation of disagreement through dialogue eg Bernard and Gilbert
- dialogue, dialect, lexical choices.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the novel should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of prose fiction methods.

0	7
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Thomas Hardy poetry selection

'Hardy's locations offer no comfort.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Hardy's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the bleakness of 'Neutral Tones'
- how the winter landscape of 'The Darkling Thrush' reflects lack of hope in speaker, but apparently comfortless thrush can sing of 'blessed Hope'
- how in 'Channel Firing' even the dead in the graveyard are disturbed and see little prospect of the world becoming 'saner'
- how there may be some comfort in the memory of childhood at home in 'The Self-Unseeing' despite not seeing the 'blessings' at the time
- how the effect of the sea on the submerged Titanic reflects loss and folly rather than comfort
- the possible solace in memories of the beloved in 'Beeny Cliff' and 'At Castle Boterel' but both poems conclude with loss
- a suggestion of the comfort of religious belief in 'The Oxen'.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- Hardy's use of a plaintive voice eg 'Beeny Cliff', 'At Castle Boterel' and 'The Darkling Thrush'
- the irony of a location where the couple are believed to be lovers, but 'never the love-light shone' in 'At an Inn'
- structure in which comfort in memories of places seems to emerge only for this to be undermined towards the end eg 'Beeny Cliff', 'At Castle Boterel' and 'The Self-Unseeing'
- structure in which some hope or comfort appears in the concluding lines, eg 'The Darkling Thrush', 'At an Inn'
- stanza form, use of rhyme, eg ironic linking of 'sinister mate' and 'gaily great', is one of several examples in 'The Convergence of the Twain'
- lexical choices, figurative language, descriptive details of locations.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

0	8
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William Wordsworth poetry selection

To what extent do you agree that the main concern of Wordsworth's poetry is to represent the beauty of nature?

You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Wordsworth's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the observation of natural beauty in features of landscape eg opening lines of 'Tintern Abbey', the 'dear nook' of hazel trees in 'Nutting', daffodils
- the cityscape as viewed from Westminster Bridge – 'a sight so touching in its majesty'
- Michael's attachment to his land and its surroundings is more than an appreciation of beauty – 'Those fields, those hills... had laid/Strong hold on his affections'
- how what is seen leads on to memories, contemplation, lessons to be learned and how these can be said to have greater significance than visual impressions eg 'Tintern Abbey', 'Nutting', 'A Narrow Girdle'
- a visit to the River Yarrow foregone in order to 'have a vision of our own'
- how the beauty of Peele Castle in its setting becomes a 'fond illusion of the heart' because of personal loss.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- structure, with observation of beauty as preliminary to thought eg 'Tintern Abbey', 'A Narrow Girdle'
- the two parts of 'Elegiac Stanzas' with contrasting details
- the narrative structure of 'Nutting', eg preparation and journey, response to 'virgin scene' with emphasis on visual impressions, abrupt change to action with 'then up I rose' and ending with reflection on boy's 'merciless ravage'
- the characterisation of Michael and description of his relationship to place
- lexical choices, eg sense impressions, philosophical observations, emotive language
- use of first person to present direct experience
- verse forms.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to the poems should be detailed and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

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Robert Frost poetry selection

Discuss the significance of Frost's locations as thought-provoking places.

You should make detailed reference to 'The Road Not Taken' and at least one other poem.
[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but as 'significance' relates to contextual, structural, linguistic and interpretative issues some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Frost's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- the speaker's reflections on decision-making and its consequences in 'The Road Not Taken'
- the broader implications of such details as 'roads', 'wood', 'path'
- reflections on loss and loneliness in 'The Black Cottage'
- attractiveness of death/suicide but continuing with life in 'Stopping by Woods...'
- the response to inner fear in 'Desert Places'
- how the night sky stimulates thoughts in 'On Looking up by Chance...' and 'An Unstamped Letter...'
- work locations and the thoughts that arise – 'Mending Wall', 'Out, Out –' and 'After Apple-Picking'.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- the structure of 'The Road Not Taken' in terms of sequence eg the placing of the choice of path, followed by consideration of the choice with a response to it
- the use of ambiguity to convey uncertainly and/or arbitrary choice eg 'better claim' and 'wanted wear' are followed by 'about the same'
- symbolism, eg woods and darkness in 'Stopping by Woods...', coalescing stars in 'An Unstamped Letter...'
- lexical choices, figurative language
- verse forms – structural use of single stanza, as well as four-line and five-line stanzas
- speech rhythms, structural use of rhyme.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3 Articulate informed, personal and creative responses to literary texts, using associated concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate written expression.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of appropriate concepts and terminology
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.

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Seamus Heaney poetry selection

‘Heaney presents his places as dominated by tension and fear.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

Some possible content is given below. It suggests some of the ways the Assessment Objectives might be addressed, but some strands listed could easily address more than one AO.

Examiners must also remember that because students have read and studied Heaney's poetry selection through the lens of **place**, the AOs must necessarily be connected to that genre through the task.

AO1 Demonstrate understanding of the ways in which readers find meanings in texts, showing an understanding of genre, the significance of contexts, and the ways in which different interpretations can be found.

Focus might be on:

- how sexual intimacy in ‘Act of Union’ is pervaded by thoughts of imperialism and aggression, the history of conflict in ‘Requiem for the Croppies’
- the violence and cruelty of ‘Punishment’ and fear shown in ‘I who have stood dumb’, how looking back in history in ‘North’ reflects present-day tension and fear but ‘dominated’ may be challenged by the consolation of making a written response
- the reflection of political unrest and the fear of punishment killings in ‘The Grauballe Man’, but ‘Bog Queen’ has a strange beauty in which her decay incorporates her in the land
- an alternative to ‘dominated’ in the growth of love in ‘A New Song’ or on home and belonging in ‘Anahorish’
- personal grief rather than tension or fear in ‘Mid-Term Break’
- features of place as inspiration in ‘Personal Helicon’.

AO2 Analyse ways in which meanings are shaped in literary texts with close attention to authorial methods.

Focus might be on:

- personal voice and tone of direct address to a partner in ‘Act of Union’ together with imagery and lexical choices from imperialist aggression and occupation
- the structure of ‘Punishment’ which develops through accumulation of detail in the description of the ‘adulteress’ with a growing personal feeling for her that is then undermined in lines 30-31 before a shift to the present in the closing two stanzas and a further sense of betrayal
- the structure of ‘North’ beginning with a sight of the sea which prompts a middle section of thoughts of Viking raiders before the final three stanzas of an imagined spoken message
- use of voice given to the dead in ‘Bog Queen’ and ‘Requiem for the Croppies’
- lexical choices and imagery in descriptions of bodies and presentation of aspects of place

- use of quatrains with variation in whether or not sentences cross stanza divisions showing, for example, continuity or changes of direction in thought.

Given that this is an **open book** exam, references to poems should be specific and accurate.

AO3 Express informed, personal and argued responses to literary texts, using appropriate concepts and terminology, and coherent, accurate writing.

With respect to skill in writing:

- quality of argument
- organisation of ideas
- use of concepts and terminology appropriate to the question
- technical accuracy.

Accept any valid interpretation and any valid discussion of poetic method.